

San Mateo police receives drone funding

Mar 25, 2023



The San Mateo Police Department has received funding to add three new drones for use in the field after City Council approval on March 20.



The council approved a purchase agreement with Axon Enterprise, a drone program for law enforcement. It calls for Axon to provide a consolidated drone program for the department's existing program and add three new drone devices. The department currently has four drones after the department started using the technology in 2020. Axon will also provide licenses, systems, maintenance and training for the program. The contract is for five years at the cost of around \$110,000. The contract amendment will cost \$48,000 in the current fiscal year and about \$15,000 each year after. The department has already contracted with Axon for body cameras, Tasers and a virtual-reality training simulation system.

A drone is an unmanned aerial device controlled remotely from the ground. The police would use the drones for scene documentation, area searches for people and evidence, disaster response, tactical operations and critical incident management, a city staff report said. The drones are not equipped with weapons and there are strict regulations on when, where, how and why police can use a drone, the staff report said. Flights must be approved by the drone unit commander and the pilot and must comply with police policy and Federal Aviation Administration flight restrictions.

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Přijmout

Bezpodstatné

The remote pilot will also focus on needed areas and not collect data on uninvolved people or places, according to the staff report. The council unanimously approved the agenda item on its consent calendar Monday.



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